

Abhi Nemani

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Summary: Senior technology executive and public sector innovator with extensive experience building and scaling organizations from startup to enterprise. Track record of successful exits and transformative public sector software reaching 500M+ people globally. Deep expertise in product strategy, go-to-market execution, and public sector digital transformation. Advanced credentials in business (Stanford eMBA), public administration (USC MPA), and finance (Wharton AFP).

Skills: Strategic leadership; product development & strategy; mergers & acquisitions; evangelism & marketing; enterprise go-to-market and sales; financial strategy; government relations; data analytics and science; and full-stack development & design (Ruby, JS, PHP, Python, HTML, CSS).

EXPERIENCE

Senior Vice President, Product Strategy

Euna Solutions

June 2023 - Present

- Drive Euna's portfolio of purpose-built financial and administrative solutions that help over 3,000 governments strengthen trust and transparency in the communities they serve. Euna's budget and grant solutions manage over \$500B in public funds, and the procurement and payments systems serve millions of residents and businesses every year.
- Direct product strategy and marketing — driving demand through product, partnerships, and thought leadership — and sales enablement to drive GTM strategy that maximizes impact. The product marketing group led integration of 10+ products into one portfolio of solutions.
- Chair Euna's AI Innovation Center, establishing company-wide artificial intelligence strategy for product innovation and operational efficiency, leveraging specialized data assets.
- Drive market demand through strategic partnerships, thought leadership, and sales enablement initiatives.
- Spearhead business intelligence and data analytics across the organization for better products and better decision-making — for Euna and for its government customers.

Founder & Managing Director

EthosLabs.us

February 2017 - June 2023

- Built and managed a portfolio of internationally recognized government technology (GovTech) startups, including SPIDRTech (acquired), CityGrows (acquired), GovDelivery (acquired), ZenCity, POLCO, HeyGov, and Camino (acquired).
- Drove growth for portfolio growth through product, go-to-market, and sales expertise, leveraging a global network of hundreds of senior government leaders to uncover unique product-market fit and scale. Ethos' companies now serve over 5,000 local governments and over 500M people worldwide.
- Developed mergers & acquisition strategy for Private Equity firms (ONEX Partners and Welsh, Carson, Anderson & Stowe), advised philanthropy (Knight Foundation & Arnold Ventures) on grantmaking and metrics/analytics, and consult corporates on enterprise growth on deals ranging from \$5M to \$2B.
- Advised senior government officials (e.g., New Jersey Attorney General & Governor of California) and non-profits to create and implement innovation strategies for economic development, talent recruitment, and IT modernization.

Civic Technology Lecturer

University of Chicago

January 2019 - September 2019

- Developed and taught first-of-its-kind course on Civic Technology for flagship Masters in Computational Analysis and Public Policy MS-CAPP) program at the Harris School for Public Policy.

Chief Innovation Officer

City of Sacramento

January 2016 - February 2017

- Developed and launched the city's landmark \$10M Innovation and Growth Fund (IGF) to promote entrepreneurship and innovation, which was approved by the city council unanimously.
- Created and administered a \$1M grant program—Rapid Acceleration, Innovation, and Leadership in Sacramento (RAILS)—to support local startups enablers, receiving 140 applications, totaling over \$17M in grant requests.
- Led first-of-its-kind investment from a municipal government in a national venture capital fund and program (500 Startups), making the city an LP and encouraging startup relocation to Sacramento.
- Built the Mayor's Office for Innovation and Entrepreneurship, recruited permanent staff (including permanent CIO) and the Mayor's Tech Council of local leaders, and codified policies and budget through City Council.

Chief Data Officer

City of Los Angeles

September 2014 - October 2015

- Led Los Angeles to #1 ranking for US Open Data cities in under one year, by publishing over 400 datasets; earned the Platinum Open Data Certification from international data consortium, WCCD.
- Built Mayoral Dashboard, which was used regularly by the Mayor and Senior Staff to increase performance and accountability. The dashboard saved the city over \$180K, was featured at the U.S. Conference of Mayors, and has been freely reused by other cities.
- Set up first-of-its-kind city data GeoHub (GIS) to share over 1,000 geospatial datasets more easily internally and externally, and deployed various critical applications atop this platform. The public-private partnership with Esri for the GeoHub became an international model for open GIS.
- Mobilized the local volunteer community to include 10K+ members that host monthly events and app competitions focused on sustainable innovation; ran the largest civic hackathon in the country.
- Supported multiple departments—e.g. Personnel and Fire—in digital transformations through training and consultations to enhance citizen experience and reduce costs; earned LA the ranking of #1 Digital City.

Co-Executive Director

Code for America

May 2010 - March 2014

Previously: Chief of Staff, Director of Strategy & Communications

- Built, launched, and ran an award-winning technology non-profit designed to transform local governments, leading product, growth, and analytics, which grew to work with hundreds of cities and became a model for the public sector innovation around the globe.
- Created a groundbreaking technology fellowship program for local governments, creating dozens of new tech solutions and roles in cities, a international volunteer network — the “Brigade” — with dozens of chapters and over 10,000 members, and CfA's policy portfolio with a focus on criminal justice reform and access to the social safety net.
- Spearheaded development of a first-of-its-kind GovTech Accelerator to drive product growth, sustainability, and scale through SaaS methodologies and capital investments. The CfA incubator produced 4 companies — OpenCounter, NextRequest, Textizen, and Remix—which all made successful exits, and CfA Accelerator alumni include ArchiveSocial (acquired), Captricity (acquired), and Aunt Bertha (Series D; EV \$100M+).
- Implemented sales and fundraising strategy for a \$15M+ budget, including foundation engagement, corporate sponsorship, and individual philanthropy. Managed and grew multi-million dollar grant relationships with Omidyar Network, Google.org, and other major national foundations, along with dozens of government contracts.
- Led communications, press relations, and marketing, generating coverage in the New York Times, The Atlantic, and Fast Company, garnering international attention, and launched global growth strategy by building sister NGO, “Code for All” with partners including the World Bank.
- Chaired Code for America Summit, the premier gathering of ~1,000 civic innovators from around the world, leading strategy, editorial, and design, growing attendance 275% and revenue 150%.

COMMUNITY & INDUSTRY INVOLVEMENT

Rose Institute of State and Local Government

Research Affiliate / Visiting Scholar

May 2023 - Present

Leading Cities (GovTech Accelerator / NGO)

Board of Directors

July 2022 - Present

Public Interest Technology University Network (PIT-UN)

University Challenge Selection Committee

May 2022 - Present

Coding it Forward (GovTech NGO)

Mentor & Speaker

Jan 2020 - Present

SmartCityX (GovTech Accelerator)

Leadership Circle

May 2019 - Present

Newsom for California (Governor)

Chair, Tech and Innovation Policy Committee

August 2017 - November 2018

OpenGov Foundation (GovTech NGO)

Board Member / Vice-Chair

May 2014 - May 2017

HONORS & RECOGNITIONS

- Mentor of the Year, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy
- Top 10 CDOs to Watch, Technical.ly
- Blair Award for State and Local Government
- Partner, Truman National Security Project
- GovTech 100 (for various startups), Government Technology Magazine
- Dean's Award for Academic Excellence, USC Price School of Public Policy
- National Fellow, Young Democrats of America
- Edward J. Sexton Fellow; Philosophy, Politics, and Economics
- Harrison Fellow, Salvatori Center for the Study of Individual Freedom in the Modern World
- Berger Award for Top Student, Claremont McKenna College
- All-American Attorney, American College Mock Trial Association
- Breakthrough Publication of the Year: Claremont Port Side (Editor-in-Chief), Center for American Progress

Recognition & Honors for Code for America

- White House Champions of Change
- Government Technology Magazine: Change-makers
- 2012 MDC Partners & Wired Humanitarian Award
- MIT Lynch Award for Urban Affairs
- 2012 Oxford Internet and Society Award

Recognition & Honors for City of Los Angeles

- #1 Open Data City, US Open Data Census
- Platinum Open Data Certification, World Council on City Data (WCCD)
- #1 Digital City, Government Technology Magazine

PUBLICATIONS

- Dashboards: The Underbelly of the Smart City | University of Missouri Kansas City Law Review (Spring 2017)
- Beyond Transparency (Book / Editor & Publisher) | Code for America Press (June 2012)
- GIS Hub Vision | ArcNews (April 2015)
- Engines of Civic Entrepreneurship | Hacker Noon (Feb 2016)
- Government as a Platform | TechCrunch (June 2012)
- How Cities Can Compete in the Future of Work | USC Price School of Public Policy (Fall 2022)
- 7 Tactics for 21st Century Government | Government Magazine (Oct 2013)
- Here's what we need for civic tech to flourish in government | Apolitical (December 2018)
- Towards a Code for Africa | World Bank Symposium (Jan 2014)
- Restoring Cities as Engines for Opportunity | CityMinded (Sept 2013)
- Turning Civic Interest into Action | Government Executive (Aug 2014)
- What's Next? | Code for America Press (June 2012)
- Accelerating San Francisco | Huffington Post (Jan 2013)

Presentations

- TEDxSacramento, "Hack of the Century: Cities"
- Texas Association of State Systems for Computing and Communications, "How the Smart City Failed"
- Federal Communications Summit (Washington DC), "Government is What We Do Together"
- Leading Cities, "GovTech Tailwinds"
- Fabric of the City (Paris), "Building an Open Data Community"
- National Association of Government Webmasters Annual Conference, "Let's Move Beyond Open Data Portals"
- Coding it Forward, "Building a Civic Tech Career"
- SXSW (Austin, TX), "Hacking for Sustainable Cities"
- University of Virginia, "The Politics, Philosophy, and Economics of Civic Tech"
- Big Kansas City, "Disruption as a Public Service"
- MAD (Hong Kong), "Civic Startups"
- Agile Alliance (Nashville, TN), "The Principles of Agile and of Government"
- World Bank (DC), "Spreading Innovation"

EDUCATION

The Wharton School

September 2021 - February 2023

Advanced Finance Program (AFP)

USC Price School of Public Policy

January 2021 - December 2022

Masters in Public Administration (MPA)

Phi Kappa Phi Honors | Dean's Award

Thesis: The Future of Work for City Governments

Stanford Graduate School of Business

August 2020 - August 2021

Executive Masters of Business Administration (eMBA)

Oxford University

August 2008 - December 2008

Philosophy, Politics & Economics (First Class)

Claremont McKenna College

August 2006 - May 2010

B.A. in Philosophy, Politics & Economics (Honors)

Magna Cum Laude